

Carmen Ramírez Folch

PhD Researcher in Political Science, European University Institute

Carmen.RamirezFolch@eui.eu · carmenramirezfolch.github.io · ORCID 0009-0000-3501-6019

Research Profile

I am a PhD researcher in political science at the European University Institute working on judicial behaviour and empirical legal studies. My research examines how judges decide gender-based violence cases, how public pressure and institutional reform shape judicial decisions, and how algorithmic decision-making affects the legitimacy of courts. I combine causal inference, survey and conjoint experiments, and text-as-data.

Education

- | | |
|-------------------------|---|
| 2023–2027
(expected) | PhD in Political and Social Sciences , European University Institute, Florence.
Supervisors: Simon Hix (EUI) and Joan-Josep Vallbé (Universitat de Barcelona). Expected defence: May/June 2027. |
| 2021–2023 | MA in Institutions and Political Economy , Universitat de Barcelona. |
| 2020–2021 | Postgraduate Diploma in Data Analysis for Political Analysis and Public Management , Universitat de Barcelona. |
| 2016–2021 | BA in Political and Administration Sciences , Universitat de Barcelona. |
| 2016–2019 | BA in Philosophy , Universitat de Barcelona. |

Research Visits

- | | |
|--------------|---|
| Oct–Dec 2026 | Visiting Researcher , Department of Politics and International Relations, University of Oxford. Host: Ezequiel González-Ocantos. |
|--------------|---|

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- Vallbé, J.-J., **Ramírez-Folch, C.**, and Lozano-Martín, M. (2026). Glass Ceiling or Merit? Gender, Promotion, and Judicial Careers in a Civil Law System. *Governance*, 39(1), e70096. doi:10.1111/gove.70096
- Vallbé, J.-J., and **Ramírez-Folch, C.** (2023). The Effect of Judges' Gender on Decisions Regarding Intimate-Partner Violence. *Journal of Empirical Legal Studies*, 20(3), 641–668. doi:10.1111/jels.12361

Working Papers

- When Does Judicial Insulation Break Down? Public Pressure and Sexual Violence Rulings in Spain** (single-authored).
Uses a high-profile sexual assault case as an exogenous shock and a difference-in-differences design on over 10,000 rulings. Conviction rates rise nationally only after the Supreme Court reversal, while judges in Navarra respond to concentrated local pressure.
- Specialized Courts, Unspecialized Institutions: Individual Learning and Organizational Stability in Gender Violence Adjudication** (with Joan-Josep Vallbé). *Under review, European Journal of Political Research*.
Exploits the staggered introduction of specialised intimate partner violence courts in Spain (2005–2019): district-level effects on convictions are modest and short-lived, while judges' conviction rates rise with experience in these courts, consistent with individual learning rather than organisational change.

- **Judge Ex Machina: Gender, Algorithmic Decision-Making, and Public Support for AI in Courts** (with Siegfried Manschein).
Compares LLM decisions with those of judges in Spanish sexual-violence cases, and uses a conjoint experiment to test how AI involvement, transparency and judge gender shape public support for courts.
- **Victim Identity and Judicial Outcomes during the Troubles** (single-authored). *Ongoing project; dataset under construction*.
Builds a dataset linking records of 3,532 conflict deaths (1969–2001) with court and archival sources to test whether, within the same perpetrator group, the path from identification to charge, conviction and sentence depends on the victim's community (Catholic or Protestant).

Applied and Policy Research

- | | |
|--------------|---|
| 2026–present | Observatori Català de la Justícia en Violència Masclista , Centre d'Estudis Jurídics i Formació Especialitzada (CEJFE), Generalitat de Catalunya. Designing a questionnaire for victims of gender-based violence and other actors in the justice process, and the focus-group and interview protocols. |
| 2026 | Gender-based violence services, Terrassa City Council , with Encarna Bodelón (Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona). Quantitative analysis of protection-order data and municipal victim-support databases. |

Research Experience

- | | |
|-----------|---|
| 2024 | Research Assistant , FEMETRICS: Visible Women – Gender, Data, Social Europe, European University Institute. Data analysis and visualisation on gender and social policy. |
| 2022–2023 | Research Assistant , RCT on nudges to improve learning and gender parity in Ghana (Elisabetta Aurino, Universitat de Barcelona). Survey data analysis in Stata and R; literature review. |
| 2022 | Research Assistant , Gender wealth-inequality project (Pilar Sorribas), Barcelona Economic Institute. Micro-data analysis in R; co-drafted the technical report. |
| 2020–2022 | Research Assistant , Political Economy of Gender and Inequality in the Spanish Judiciary (Joan-Josep Vallbé), Universitat de Barcelona. Web-scraped and merged judicial datasets in R. |

Conference Presentations

- | | |
|------|---|
| 2026 | American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Boston; European Political Science Society (EPSS) Annual Conference, Belfast; ECPR European Conference on Politics and Gender (ECPG), Newcastle. All with <i>Judge Ex Machina</i> (with Siegfried Manschein). |
| 2025 | European Political Science Association (EPSA) Annual Conference, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid
CIVICA Political Behavior and Institutions (PoBI) Conference, Central European University |
| 2024 | Workshop on Social Science Approaches to Law and Courts, University College London
FEMETRICS – Visible Women: Gender, Data, Social Europe Conference, European University Institute |
| 2023 | Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference, Chicago. <i>Glass Ceiling or Merit?</i> (with Joan-Josep Vallbé and Mario Lozano-Martín) |

Academic Service

2024–2025 **Co-founder and co-organiser**, Gender Colloquium, European University Institute.
2024–2025 **Co-organiser**, Comparative Politics Seminar Series, European University Institute.

Methods and Skills

Methods	Causal inference (difference-in-differences, event studies, matching); survey and conjoint experiments; text-as-data and large language models.
Software	R, Python, Stata, $\text{\LaTeX}$.
Languages	Spanish (native), Catalan (native), English (C1), Italian (B1), French (basic).